Taming Windows 11
An Intune Adventure

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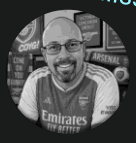
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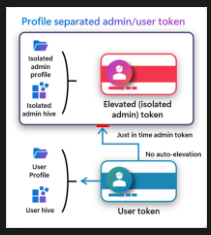
Administrator Protection

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3

Administrator Protection

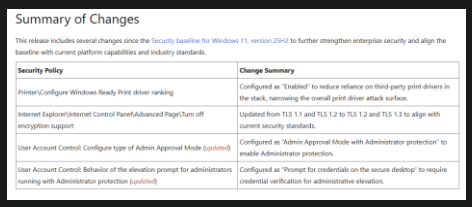
- **Just-in-time elevation:** Users remain deprivileged between admin tasks. Each task gets a new admin token, discarded after use.
- **Profile separation:** Hidden, system-generated accounts create isolated admin tokens, helping protect elevated sessions from user-level malware.
- **No auto-elevations:** Users must interactively authorize every admin operation.
- **Windows Hello integration:** Windows Hello provides simple, secure authorization.



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4

Security baseline Windows 11-26H2



Summary of Changes

This release includes several changes since the Security baseline for Windows 11, version 25H2 to further strengthen enterprise security and align the baseline with current platform capabilities and industry standards.

Security Policy	Change Summary
Printer\Configure Windows Ready Print driver ranking	Configured as "Enabled" to reduce reliance on third-party print drivers in the stack, narrowing the overall print driver attack surface.
Internet Explorer\Internet Control Panel\Advanced Page\Turn off encryption support	Updated from TLS 1.1 and TLS 1.2 to TLS 1.2 and TLS 1.3 to align with current security standards.
User Account Control: Configure type of Admin Approval Mode (updated)	Configured as "Admin Approval Mode with Administrator protection" to enable Administrator protection.
User Account Control: Behavior of the elevation prompt for administrators running with Administrator protection (updated)	Configured as "Prompt for credentials on the secure desktop" to require credential verification for administrative elevation.

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5

Monitoring and Reporting

Administrator protection tracks elevations with two new Event Tracing for Windows (ETW) events.

Existing provider: Microsoft-Windows-LUA GUID *{93c05d69-51a3-485e-877f-1806a8731346}*

Event ID	Event Name	Description
15031	Elevation Approved	Logged when a user successfully authenticates and elevation is granted
15032	Elevation Denied/Fail	Logged when elevation is denied, fails, or times out

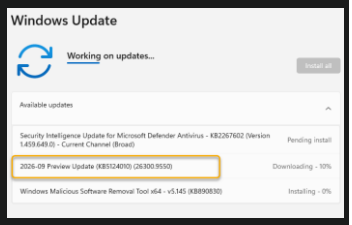
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KB5124010 fixes key issues

Missing Start menu icons
Fixes missing launch icons after some app installations.

Unexpected elevation prompts
Fixes unnecessary elevation requests from some apps using Edge extensions.



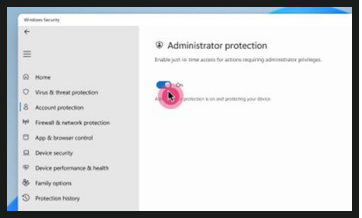
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7

Something to look forward to…

Windows Insider preview
This option is currently available only in Windows Insider builds.

Gradual rollout
It will roll out to everyone gradually.



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8

Windows 365:
Data Protection

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9

Cloud PC: Device redirections

Redirection	Policy
Audio input	Allow audio recording redirection
Audio output	Allow audio and video playback redirection
Cameras	Do not allow video capture redirection
Clipboard	Do not allow Clipboard redirection
COM ports	Do not allow COM port redirection
Drives	Do not allow drive redirection
Location	Do not allow location redirection
Printers	Do not allow client printer redirection
Smartcards	Do not allow smart card device redirection
USB drives	Do not allow supported Plug and Play device redirection

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10

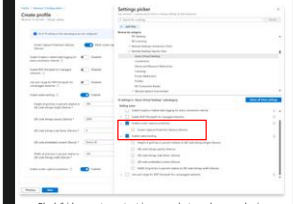
Data Protection

Watermarking



Add traceable watermarks

Screen capture protection



Block/hide remote content in screenshots and screen sharing

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11

Screen capture protection (try to take a print screen)



Print screen = black screen

Screen capture protection (try to share in Teams)



Teams sharing = black screen

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12

Watermarking: Good to know

Watermarking support in Windows 365

Watermarking support is configured on session hosts and enforced by the Remote Desktop client. The settings for Watermarking support can be configured via Group Policy (GPO) or the Intune Settings Catalog. The default for the QR code embedded content setting doesn't allow administrators to look up device information from leaked images for Cloud PCs.

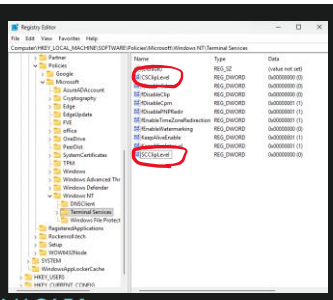
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13

> **Important**
>
> - Network drives that are disconnected aren't redirected. Once the network drives are reconnected, they're not automatically redirected during the remote session. You need to disconnect and reconnect to the remote session to redirect the network drives.
> - If you disable drive redirection using Intune or Group Policy, it also prevents files being transferred between the local device and remote session using the clipboard. Other content, such as text or images, isn't affected.

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14



CS =

Client -> Server

SC =

Server -> Client

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15

Remove Built-in Apps
The Modern Way

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16

In-box app removal requirements

- Windows Enterprise or Education only (Pro is not supported)
- Version 25H2 or later

When the policy applies

- Out-of-box experience (OOBE)
- Sign-in after an OS upgrade
- Sign-in after a policy update

Important limitations

Multi-session environments are not supported.

App removal applies to the whole device and affects every user.

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17

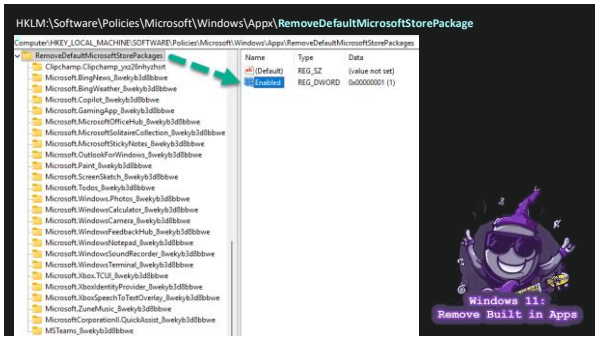
Administrative templates -> Windows components -> App package deployment -> **Remove Default Microsoft Store packages from the system**

Feedback Hub (Device)	False
Microsoft 365 Copilot (Device)	False
Microsoft Clipchamp (Device)	True
Microsoft Copilot (Device)	False
Microsoft News (Device)	False
Microsoft Photos ** (Device)	False

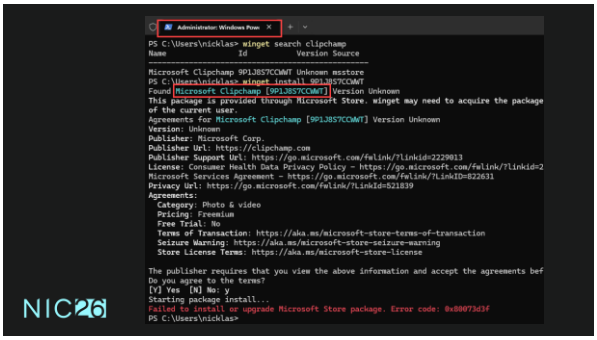
True = Remove
False = Keep

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18



19



20

Windows 11
Smart App Control

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21

Smart App Control: Disable

Before 26H2 =

Reinstall Windows 👎

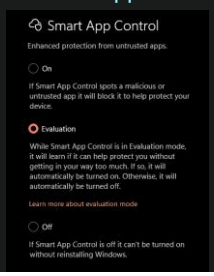
26H2 (Fresh Install) =

No need to reinstall Windows after disabling Smart App Control 👍

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22

Fresh Install - Smart App Control = Evaluation



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23

Windows
~~Backup For Organizations~~
Settings Backup and Restore

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24

Restore my stuff during OOBE.. YES please!

- Tenant-wide = During device enrollment
- Settings Catalog = After device enrollment
- Supports AVD/CloudPCs (at first sign in after device enrollment)
- Windows Backup app is installed with the backup policy
- Combine with MS Edge Enterprise sync?

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25

Windows settings **Backup** in 26H2

Enabled by default on eligible devices

Starting with Windows 11, version 26H2.

Existing administrator policies still apply

Windows continues to honor any existing administrator-configured policy, whether enabled or disabled.

NIC26 This change applies only to backup policies; admins must still configure restore policies.

26

How it works

Backup

1. We enable and configure a backup policy (**26H2** = enabled by default)
2. A scheduled task will initiate the backup of a Windows device

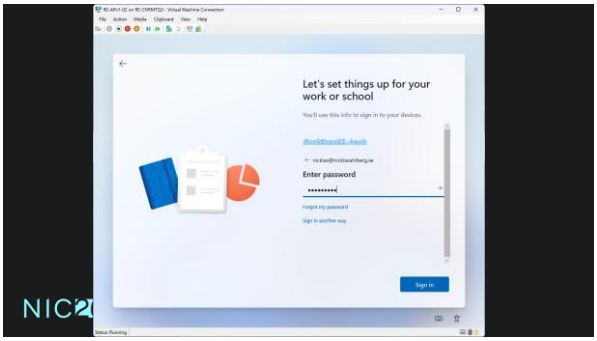
   Every 8 days
3. Optional: Use the Windows Backup app to manually initiate a backup

Restore

1. We must enable and configure a restore policy (per device/user or tenant-wide)
2. User signs in during OOBE
3. Restore page is shown

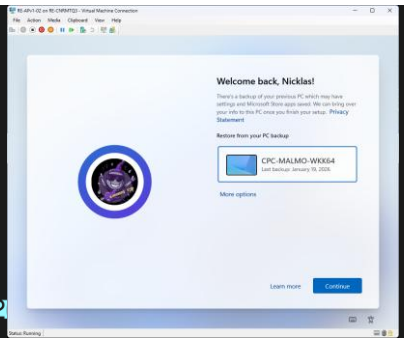
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27



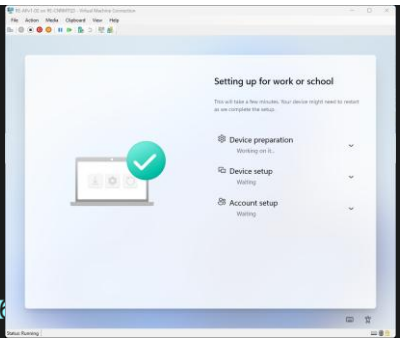
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28



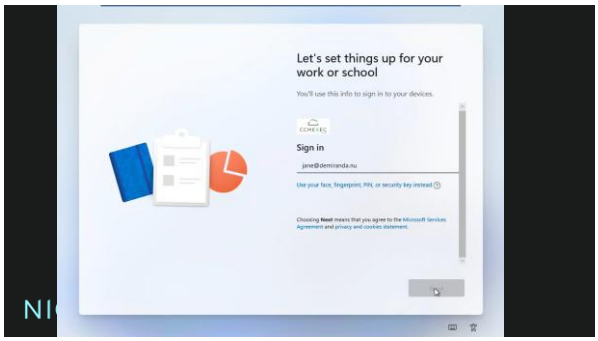
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29



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30



31

Enterprise State Roaming (ESR)

Moved to Windows Settings Backup and Restore (2026-June)

💡If you take no action, Windows will honor both ESR and GPO/MDM roaming controls for one year (prioritizing GPO/MDM); after that, ESR will no longer work, and roaming must be managed through Windows Backup for Organizations policies.

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32

Windows 11

First Sign-in Restore

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33

At first sign in instead of during OOBE

- Restore your stuff at first sign-in instead of during OOBE
- If a user decides not to restore during OOBE, this is honored during first sign-in as well
- Enabled per group instead of tenant-wide
- Requires Windows 11 24H2/25H2 and **2026-03** CU
- Enables Windows365 / AVD scenarios

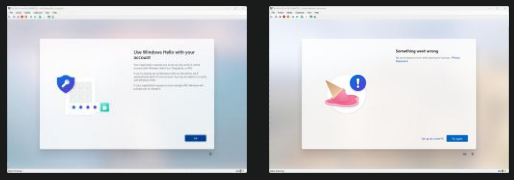
💡Make sure backups have been taken.. no backup = nothing to restore

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34

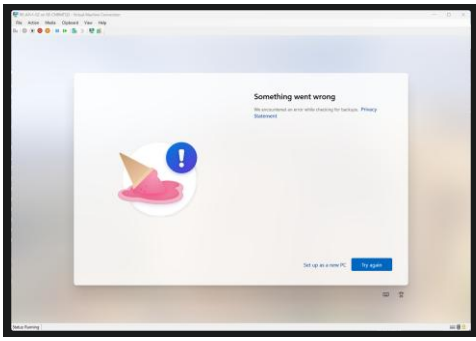
Good to know

Phishing resistant MFA is supported. Remember to exclude **d32c68ad-72d2-4acb-a0c7-46bb2cf93873** from CA

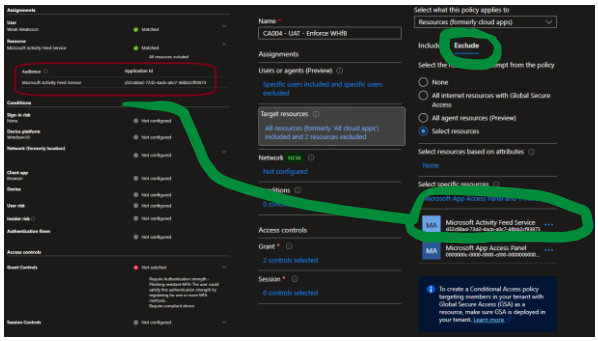


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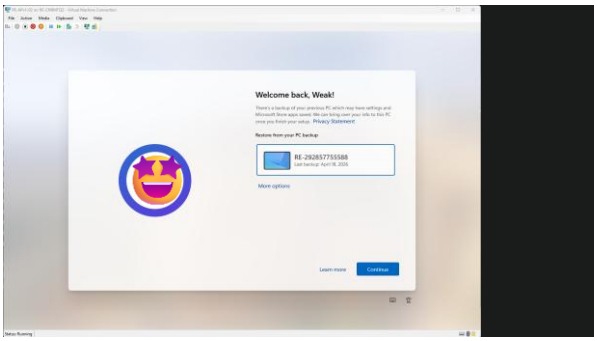
35



36



37



38

Windows 11
Timezone

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39

Harder Than You Think

Auto time zone detection depends on the Windows location service

- Location Service is often disabled by policy, blocked by firewall

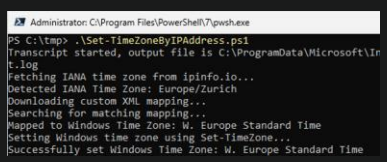
Wrong time zone = confused users = Tickets

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40

Demo

- Time Zone By Script



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41

Windows 11
Start layout

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42

Out of the box experience...



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43

What's New?

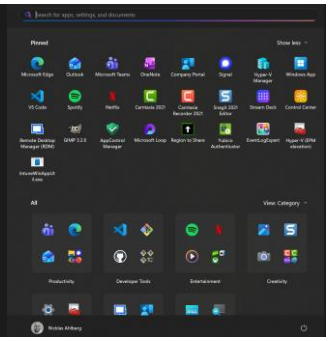
- Windows 10 used XML-based LayoutModification.xml - deprecated in Windows 11
- Windows 11 introduced JSON-based layout configuration
- New "Recommended" section, new pinning behavior, new challenges
- Admins need a fresh approach for managed desktops

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44

New setting!

HideCategoryView



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45

How Can We Manage This via Intune?

- Settings Catalog: ConfigureTaskbarPins (JSON-based)
- Settings Catalog: Start Menu layout (pinned apps, folder groups)
- Full lockdown vs. partial layout (forced vs. user-customisable)

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46

JSON Setting

Export-StartLayout -Path "C:\YourStartMenuLayout.json"

```
{
   "applyOnce":true,
   "pinnedList":[
      {"desktopAppLink":"%ALLUSERSPROFILE%\\...\\Microsoft Edge.lnk"},
      {"desktopAppId":"Microsoft.Office.OUTLOOK.EXE.15"},
      {"desktopAppId":"Microsoft.Office.WINWORD.EXE.15"},
      {"packagedAppId":"Microsoft.WindowsNotepad_8wekyb3d8bbwe!App"}
   ]
}
```

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The applyOnce property is supported starting with Windows 11, version 24H2 with KB5062660 and it's ignored on earlier versions of Windows 11.

47

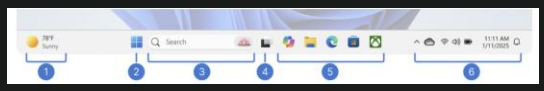
Taskbar Pinning

- JSON defines which apps appear pinned on the taskbar
- Apps must be installed on the device, otherwise the pin silently fails
- Blue = Windows Default
- Red = User choice
- Green = Policy



48

The Windows taskbar



1 Widgets
2 Start
3 Search
4 Task view
5 Applications
6 System tray

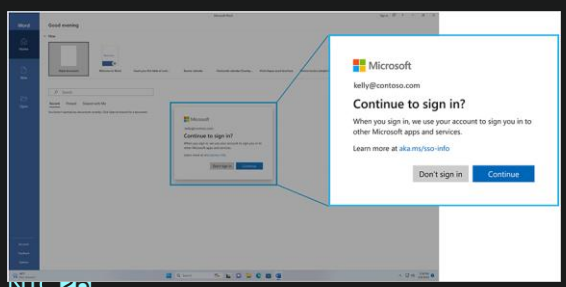
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49

Windows 11
Admin control for SSO prompts

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50



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51

Admin control for SSO prompts in Windows

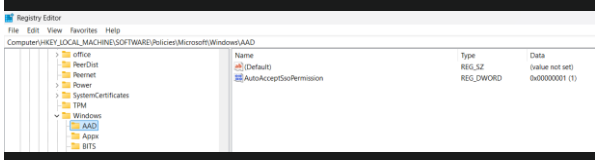
- New in Windows 11 24H2, 25H2, 26H2 since July 2026
- Admin can now accept Single-Sign on Accept prompt on behalf of the organization.
- ✅ Entra ID organization accounts
- ❌ Personal Microsoft accounts

Not in the settings catalog yet

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52

Registry value



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53

PowerShell Script

```powershell
<#
.SYNOPSIS
    Ensures the AutoAcceptSsoPermission registry value is set for Azure AD SSO policy.

.DESCRIPTION
    Checks and enforces the DWORD value AutoAcceptSsoPermission = 1 under the
    AAD Group Policy registry key. Creates the key or value if missing.

.NOTES
    Requires local administrator rights or System rights to write to HKLM.
#>
param()

$registryPath = 'HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\AAD'
$valueName = 'AutoAcceptSsoPermission'
$expectedValue = 1

# Create the AAD policy key if it does not exist
if (-not (Test-Path $registryPath)) {
    New-Item -Path $registryPath -Force | Out-Null
    Write-Host "Created registry path '$registryPath'."
}
```

54

Ignore
Windows Update GPOs

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55

Windows Update to Intune: challenges

Policy conflicts
Legacy policies can keep devices on WSUS or block Windows Update.

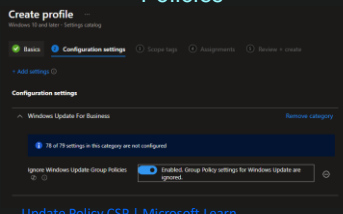
Uneven handover
Enrollment or targeting gaps can leave ConfigMgr in control.

Rollback limits
Switching back does not undo installed Windows versions.

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56

New Setting: Ignore Windows Update Group Policies

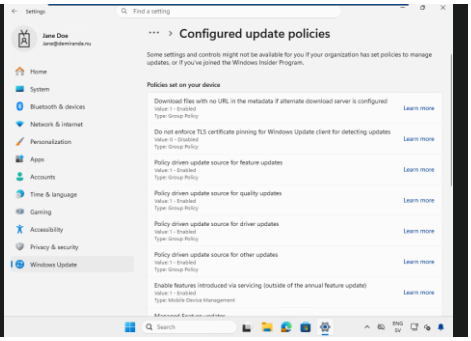


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Update Policy CSP | Microsoft Learn

57

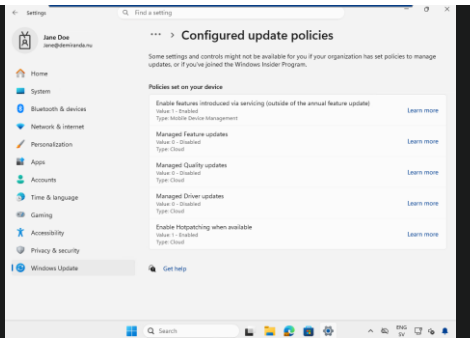
Before



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58

After



NIC26

59

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60